

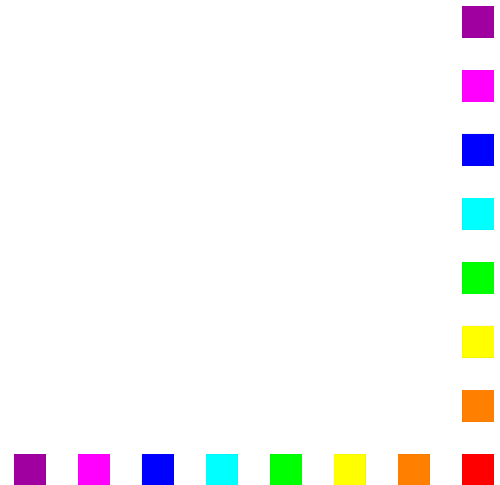
COBOL Basics

2

Group Items/Records

WORKING-STORAGE SECTION.

01 StudentDetails PIC X(26) .



Group Items/Records

WORKING-STORAGE SECTION.

01 StudentDetails.

02 StudentName PIC X(10) .

02 StudentId PIC 9(7) .

02 CourseCode PIC X(4) .

02 Grant PIC 9(4) .

02 Gender PIC X.

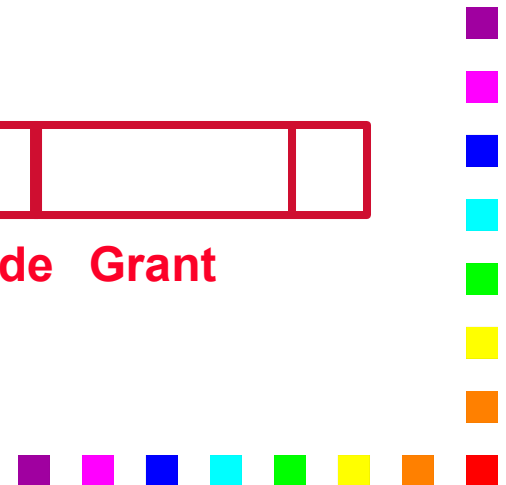
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StudentName
Gender

StudentId

CourseCode

Grant



Group Items/Records

WORKING-STORAGE SECTION.

01 StudentDetails.

02 StudentName.

03 Surname PIC X(8).

03 Initials PIC XX.

02 StudentId PIC 9(7).

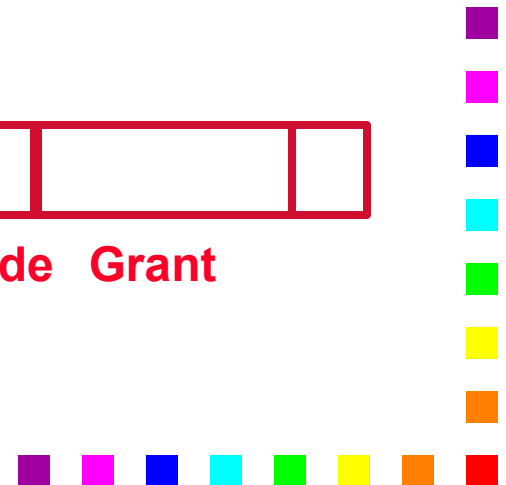
02 CourseCode PIC X(4).

02 Grant PIC 9(4).

02 Gender PIC X.

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StudentName	StudentId	CourseCode	Grant
Surname	Gender	Initials	



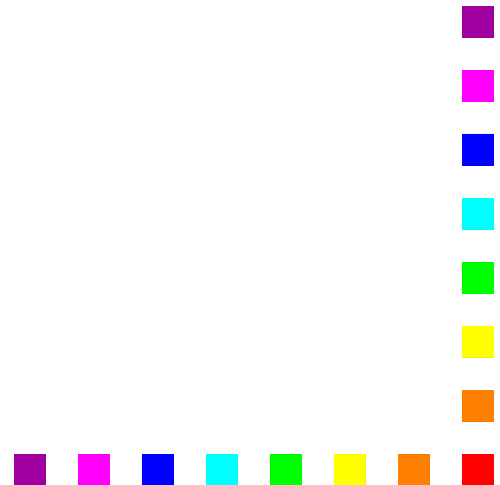
LEVEL Numbers express DATA hierarchy

In COBOL, **level numbers** are used to decompose a structure into its constituent parts.

In this hierarchical structure the higher the level number, the lower the item is in the hierarchy. At the lowest level the data is completely atomic.

The level numbers **01** through **49** are general level numbers but there are also special level numbers such as 66, 77 and **88**.

In a hierarchical data description what is important is the **relationship** of the level numbers to one another, not the actual level numbers used.



LEVEL Numbers express DATA hierarchy

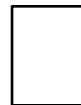
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In a hierarchical data description what is important is the relationship of the level numbers to one another, not the actual level numbers used.

```
01 StudentDetails.  
  02 StudentName.  
    03 Surname      PIC X(8).  
    03 Initials     PIC XX.  
  02 StudentId      PIC 9(7).  
  02 CourseCode     PIC X(4).  
  02 Grant          PIC 9(4).  
  02 Gender         PIC X.
```



```
01 StudentDetails.  
  05 StudentName.  
    10 Surname      PIC X(8).  
    10 Initials     PIC XX.  
  05 StudentId      PIC 9(7).  
  05 CourseCode     PIC X(4).  
  05 Grant          PIC 9(4).  
  05 Gender         PIC X.
```

Group and elementary items.

In COBOL the term “**group item**” is used to describe a data item which has been further subdivided.

A Group item is declared using **GROUP**
cannot have a picture clause

Where a group item is the highest level item in a hierarchy
referred to as a **record** and used as a **01**

The term “**elementary item**” is used to describe data items which are atomic; that is, not further subdivided.

An elementary item declaration consists of;

must

Every group or elementary item declaration **must** be followed by a full stop.

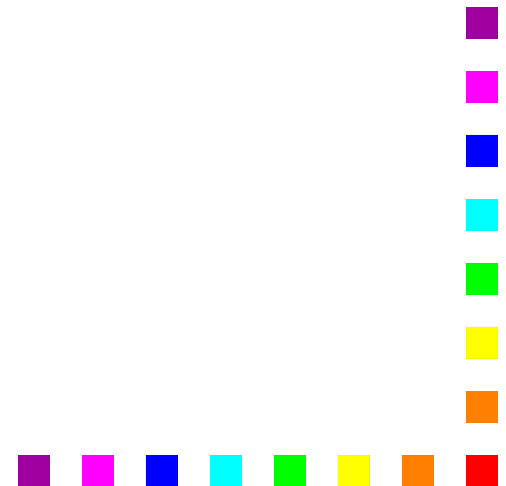


PICTUREs for Group Items

Picture clauses are **NOT** specified for 'group' data items because the **size** a group item is the sum of the sizes of its subordinate, elementary items and its **type** is always assumed to be **PIC X**.

The type of a group items is always assumed to be PIC X because group items may have several different data items and types subordinate to them.

An X picture is the only one which could support such collections.



Assignment in COBOL

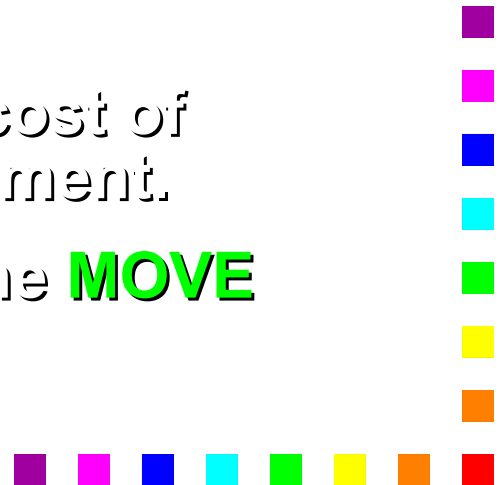
In “strongly typed” languages like Modula-2, Pascal or ADA the assignment operation is simple because assignment is only allowed between data items with compatible types.

The simplicity of assignment in these languages is achieved at the “cost” of having a large number of data types.

In COBOL there are basically only three data types,

But this simplicity is achieved only at the cost of having a very complex assignment statement.

In COBOL assignment is achieved using the **MOVE** verb.



The MOVE Verb

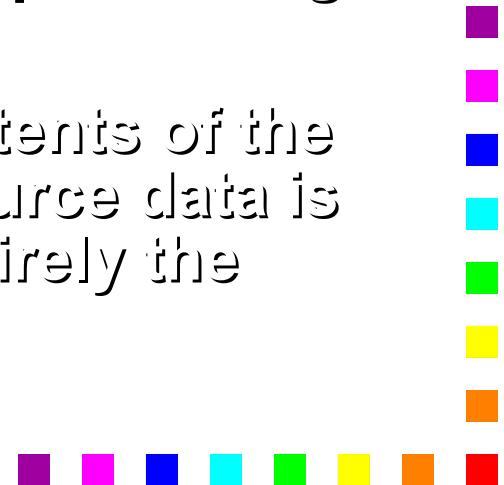
MOVE $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{Identifier} \\ \text{Literal} \end{array} \right\}$ TO {Identifier} ...

The **MOVE** copies data from the source identifier or literal to one or more destination identifiers.

The source and destination identifiers can be group or elementary data items.

When the destination item is alphanumeric or alphabetic (PIC X or A) data is copied into the destination area from **left** to **right** with space filling or truncation on the right.

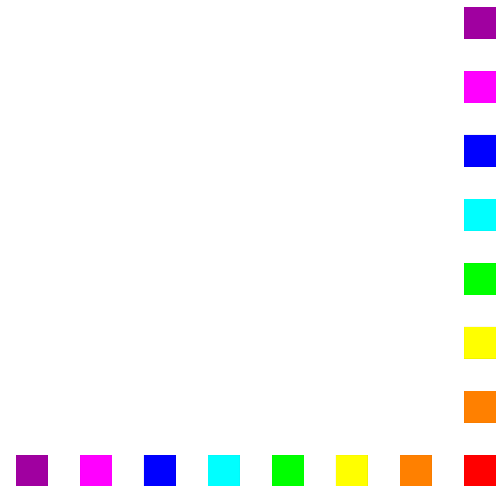
When data is MOVED into an item the contents of the item are completely **replaced**. If the source data is too small to fill the destination item entirely the remaining area is **zero** or **space filled**.



MOVEing Data

```
MOVE "RYAN" TO Surname.  
MOVE "FITZPATRICK" TO Surname.
```

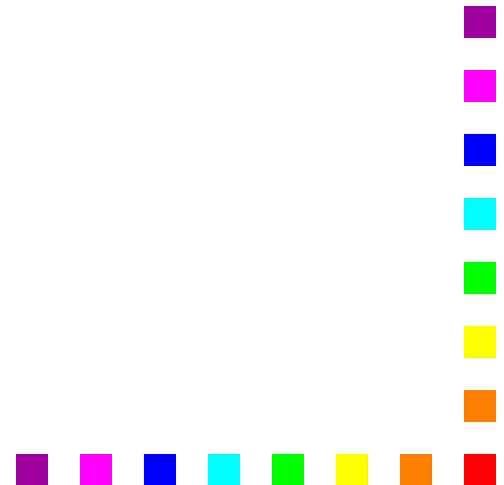
C	O	U	G	H	L	A	N
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---



MOVEing Data

MOVE "RYAN" TO Surname.
MOVE "FITZPATRICK" TO Surname.

R	Y	A	N				
---	---	---	---	--	--	--	--

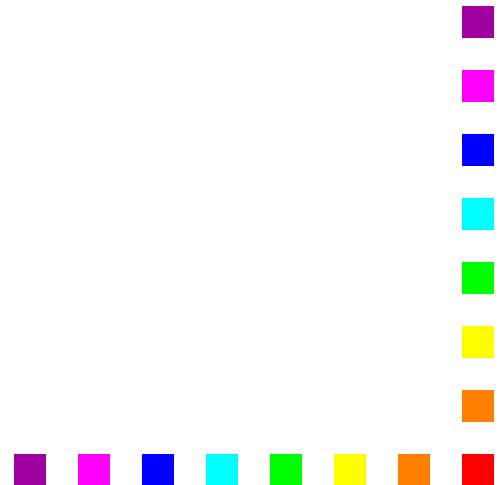


MOVEing Data

MOVE "RYAN" TO Surname.

MOVE "FITZPATRICK" TO Surname.

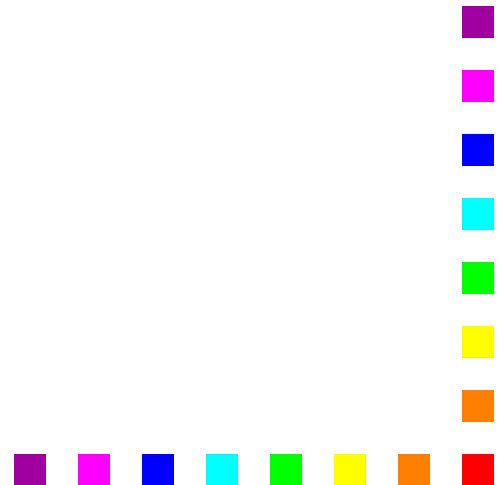
F	I	T	Z	P	A	T	R	I	C	K
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---



MOVEing to a numeric item.

When the destination item is numeric, or edited numeric, then data is aligned along the **decimal point** with zero filling or truncation as necessary.

When the decimal point is not explicitly specified in either the source or destination items, the item is treated as if it had an assumed decimal point immediately after its rightmost character.



01 GrossPay PIC 9(4)V99.

MOVE ZEROS TO GrossPay.

MOVE 12.4 TO GrossPay.

MOVE 123.456 TO GrossPay.

MOVE 12345.757 TO GrossPay.

0 0 0 0 0 0

!

0 0 1 2 4 0

!

0 1 2 3 4 5 6

!

1 2 3 4 5 7 5 7

!

```
01 CountyPop      PIC 999.  
01 Price          PIC 999V99.
```

```
MOVE 1234 TO CountyPop.
```

```
MOVE 12.4 TO CountyPop.
```

```
MOVE 154 TO Price.
```

```
MOVE 3552.75 TO Price.
```

1 2 3 4

↓

0 1 2 4

↓

1 5 4 0 0

↓

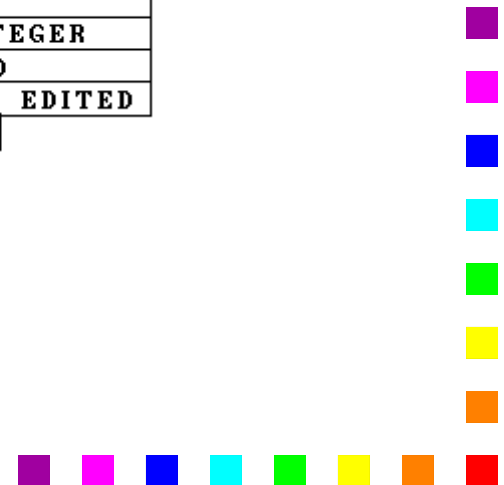
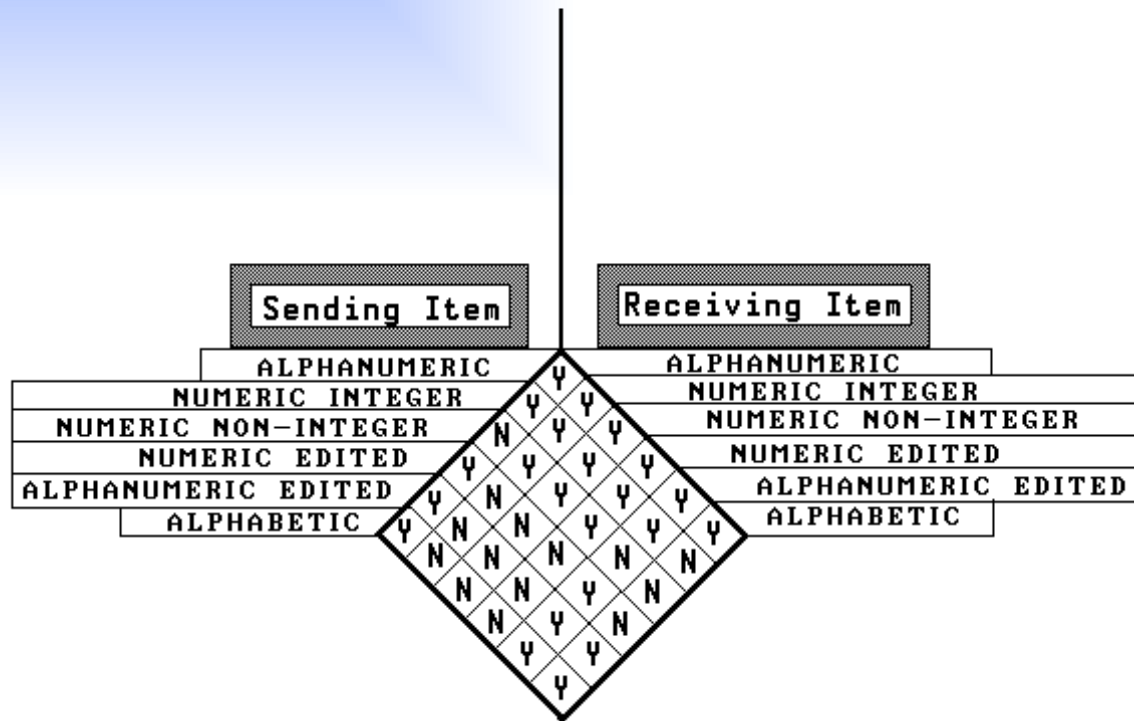
3 5 5 2 7 5

↓

Legal MOVES

Certain combinations of sending and receiving data types are not permitted (even by COBOL).

MOVE COMBINATIONS.



The **DISPLAY** Verb

DISPLAY $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{Identifier} \\ \text{Literal} \end{array} \right\} \left[\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{Identifier} \\ \text{Literal} \end{array} \right\} \right] \dots$

$\left[\underline{\text{UPON}} \text{ Mnemonic - Name} \right] \left[\text{WITH } \underline{\text{NO ADVANCING}} \right]$

From time to time it may be useful to display messages and data values on the screen.

A simple **DISPLAY** statement can be used to achieve this.

A single DISPLAY can be used to display several data items or literals or any combination of these.

The **WITH NO ADVANCING** clause suppresses the carriage return/line feed.



The ACCEPT verb

Format 1. ACCEPT Identifier [FROM Mnemonic - name]

Format 2. ACCEPT Identifier FROM {
DATE
DAY
DAY - OF - WEEK
TIME}

```
01 CurrentDate      PIC 9(6) .
```

```
* YYMMDD
```

```
01 DayOfYear        PIC 9(5) .
```

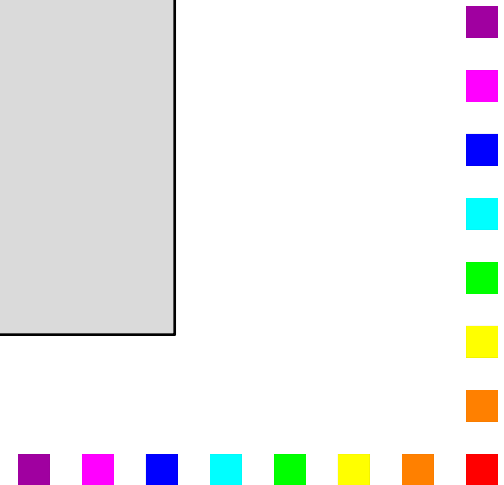
```
* YYDDD
```

```
01 DayOfWeek        PIC 9 .
```

```
* D (1=Monday)
```

```
01 CurrentTime      PIC 9(8) .
```

```
* HHMMSSss    s = S/100
```



Run of Accept and Display program

Enter student details using template below

NNNNNNNNNNSSSSSSSSCCCGGGGS

COUGHLANMS9476532LM511245M

Name is MS COUGHLAN

Date is 24 01 94

Today is day 024 of the year

The time is 22:23

```
$ SET SOURCEFORMAT"FREE"
IDENTIFICATION DIVISION.
PROGRAM-ID.    AcceptAndDisplay.
AUTHOR.    Michael Coughlan.
```

DATA DIVISION.

WORKING-STORAGE SECTION.

01 StudentDetails.

02 StudentName.

03 Surname PIC X(8).

03 Initials PIC XX.

02 StudentId PIC 9(7).

02 CourseCode PIC X(4).

02 Grant PIC 9(4).

02 Gender PIC X.

01 CurrentDate.

02 CurrentYear PIC 99.

02 CurrentMonth PIC 99.

02 CurrentDay PIC 99.

01 DayOfYear.

02 FILLER PIC 99.

02 YearDay PIC 9(3).

01 CurrentTime.

02 CurrentHour PIC 99.

02 CurrentMinute PIC 99.

02 FILLER PIC 9(4).

PROCEDURE DIVISION.

Begin.

DISPLAY "Enter student details using template below".

DISPLAY "NNNNNNNNNNSSSSSSSSCCCGGGGS".

ACCEPT StudentDetails.

ACCEPT CurrentDate FROM DATE.

ACCEPT DayOfYear FROM DAY.

ACCEPT CurrentTime FROM TIME.

DISPLAY "Name is ", Initials SPACE Surname.

DISPLAY "Date is " CurrentDay SPACE CurrentMonth SPACE CurrentYear.

DISPLAY "Today is day " YearDay " of the year".

DISPLAY "The time is " CurrentHour ":" CurrentMinute.

STOP RUN.